

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1990-04-20

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

1 dear bahá'í friends,

T twenty-five years ago, when the international deputization fund was

2 friends were invited to contribute to it in support of pioneering and travel-ing
teaching projects throughout the world, these illuminating words of

3 bahá'u'lláh were quoted:

center your energies in the propagation of the faith of god. whoso is

4 worthy of so high a calling, let him arise and promote it. whoso is un-

5 able, it is his duty to appoint him who will, in his stead, proclaim this

6 revelation, whose power hath caused the foundations of the mighti-88.9

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90 1986–1992 • The Six Year Plan

91 159est structures to quake, every mountain to be crushed into dust, and

every soul to be dumbfounded. . . .89-1

92 it is clear from this injunction of bahá'u'lláh's that the primary responsibil-

93 ity to promote the propagation of the faith of god rests on the individual

94 believer. it is, likewise, his responsibility, if he is unable to discharge this

95 duty, to appoint one who will, in his stead, proclaim this r evelation.

many of the friends have, ever since these words were revealed by

96 bahá'u'lláh, succeeded in responding to the call. A great number have not

97 found it easy to select suitable and qualified deputies willing to undertake such a task
for them.

we feel that the time has come, as the bahá'í world is rapidly moving

98 towards the end of the Six year plan, for National Spiritual Assemblies to

99 take an active part in facilitating the selection and appointment of suitable pioneers
and traveling teachers, by providing a link between those wishing to deputize, and those
qualified and ready to be deputized. The manner in

100 which this objective can be achieved is left to the discretion of each National

101 Spiritual Assembly, which should consider the conditions of its national community,
and determine, preferably in consultation with the counselors

102 or their representatives, the wisest and most effective course of action to

103 follow. it is hoped that whatever procedures are adopted, they will assist the

104 friends to fulfill their responsibilities, to the extent possible, in the manner

105 prescribed by b ahá'u'lláh.

106 The way is, of course, always open for the friends to use the international

107 deputization fund as the vehicle of their compliance with bahá'u'lláh's in-

108 junction. Thus, those who are unable, or find it difficult, to identify suitable
candidates to be designated as their deputies are able to send their contribu-

109 tions to the international deputization fund on a regular basis in order to

110 fulfill their sacred obligation for the promotion of the teaching work.

111 responsibility for the administration of this fund has been assigned to

112 the international Teaching center and, in its turn, the Teaching center

113 makes specific allocations through the continental pioneer committees,

whose memberships have recently been renewed and made known to the

114 friends. A few months ago short-term pioneer projects were announced and

115 89-1. gwb, no. 96.3.89.2

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90 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

91 160the concept of short-term pioneers has been received with great excitement

92 by the friends everywhere. whenever supplementary funds are needed to as-

93 sist in the prosecution of these projects, or to finance long-term pioneering and
traveling teaching projects, application could be made to the interna-

94 tional deputization fund. National Spiritual Assemblies, therefore, could

95 work out cost estimates of projects needing financial support, and submit

96 their requests for budget assistance to the continental pioneer committees.

The occasion demands that the followers of bahá'u'lláh should whole-

97 heartedly, with fresh enthusiasm and renewed dedication, step into this

98 arena of service. it is our hope and prayer that through such universal

99 participation in this mighty endeavor, those whose circumstances do not enable them
at this time to fulfill the beloved's call, as clearly enunciated

100 in his celebrated passage quoted above, will discharge their obligation by

101 contributing to the international deputation fund, thus providing the

102 means whereby others may propel the remaining stages of the Six year plan

103 to a triumphant conclusion.

104 with loving bahá'í greetings,

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Riḍván Message 1990

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]